

Geldermalsen

Sunken treasure

Date of sinking 1752

Depth of water Less than 33 ft (10 m)

Rediscovery date 1985

The cargo of a wrecked ship can be very valuable. When the 18th-century Dutch trading ship *Geldermalsen* sank near Singapore, it was carrying Chinese porcelain and gold that were salvaged and sold in 1986 for more than 15 million dollars. The ship was also carrying tea, which, at that time, was more valuable than its cargo of gold.



Central America

Lost gold

Date of sinking 1857

Depth of water 7,220 ft (2,200 m)

Rediscovery date 1988

When the paddle steamer *Central America* sank in a hurricane off the Atlantic coast of the US, it was carrying 10 tons (9 metric tons) of gold mined in California. The shipwreck was in deep water, and part of the cargo (seen here) was recovered using a remotely operated submersible. The value of the gold found so far exceeds 100 million dollars.



Titanic

Into the deep



Date of sinking 1912

Depth of water 12,415 ft (3,784 m)

Rediscovery date 1985

The most famous shipwreck of all is the *Titanic*. On its maiden voyage, it hit a north Atlantic iceberg at full speed and sank to the ocean floor. The ship was found using a remotely controlled submersible, but manned submersibles including *Alvin* and the two *Mir* crafts were then used to explore, photograph, and film it. Some items have also been recovered from the site.

► GHOST SHIP

The rail above the bow of Titanic is still intact, but the vast, rusting hull is very fragile and may be close to collapse.

